



AuthorsLab

Every author deserves an editorial team.

AI editors that carry a manuscript from upload to polished, publishable book — for the price of a paperback a month.

Pre-seed • £350,000 • August 2026

Finishing a book is cheap. Publishing it well costs thousands.

**\$2,000-
\$10,000+**

typical cost of professional editing for one manuscript (verified market pricing, 2026)

£7,000

median annual income of a UK professional author — down 38% in real terms since 2018 (ALCS)

44%

of surveyed indie authors earn under \$100/month from their books — yet committed indies out-earn traditionally published peers (ALLi)

The people with the most books in them can least afford the editorial team that traditional publishing takes for granted.

A named editorial team, on subscription



Alex

Developmental editor — structure, pacing, character



Sam

Line editor — voice, rhythm, clarity



Jordan

Copy editor — grammar, consistency, polish

Live at launch

Upload your manuscript. Work chapter by chapter with all three editors.
Download the polished result. A dashboard holds every project.

And the rest of the journey, releasing in stages



Wright — drafting collaborator for the book still in your head



Taylor — Design — cover art generation and a full cover composer



Publishing Hub — formats, metadata, publish-ready files



Kai — Marketing Hub — launch planning and campaign copy



Riley — a companion who remembers your whole journey

Upload. Edit. Download.

1

Upload

Free full-manuscript assessment by Alex — no card required. The manuscript is parsed into chapters, the author sees exactly what the editors see.



2

Edit

Full-manuscript editorial passes through the three-editor team, metered by plan. Every AI call is logged with tokens and cost — the author sees progress, we see unit economics.



3

Download

A polished, publishable manuscript. Every version preserved. The dashboard carries as many projects as the plan allows.

Free analysis is the funnel. The product is the journey.

Committed authors already spend — on a stack of partial tools

Panel-verified market research, 25 sources, July 2026:

\$34/mo

what a committed indie pays today to replicate our scope: Sudowrite Pro + Scrivener + ProWritingAid — three tools, none covering the journey

\$636/mo

average indie marketing spend (self-reported; ~\$81/mo even among sub-\$100 earners)

**\$250–
\$1,999**

per book, editing spend by successful indies (\$10k+/mo earners)

£600/mo

what small UK imprints pay Consonance for editorial SaaS — our separate B2B axis

The market is bimodal: price the commitment, not the average. Our tiers are built for exactly that.

Tiers are capacity, not features — live on Stripe today

Starter £7/mo billed annually £10/mo billed monthly 1 editorial pass / month 1 active project	Author £13/mo billed annually £19/mo billed monthly 4 editorial passes / month Unlimited projects	Pro £27/mo billed annually £39/mo billed monthly 10 editorial passes / month Unlimited projects + priority	£119 one-time single-project pass — credits toward membership within 90 days Imprint SKU £250–£1,000/mo
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- No feature gating — every author gets the whole team (the pattern that wins in this market: Sudowrite, not gated suites).
- Each product release lands inside existing tiers; new-customer prices step up while early subscribers keep their price for life.
- 11 beta authors grandfathered as Founding Authors at £9.50/mo — loyalty engineered in before launch.

We meter our COGS per AI call. Most pre-seeds guess.

Every LLM call across the platform routes through one cell and writes to a ledger: station, model, tokens, latency, cost — per author, per manuscript.

Pricing calibrated to measured cost

Analysis allowances per tier are sized from instrument readings, not estimates — targeted $\geq 70\%$ flagship gross margin.

First readings already in

A full developmental pass costs $\sim £0.40$ – $£0.80$ uncached — half our conservative planning figure. Prompt caching cuts input cost a further 90%.

Margin risk is visible, not hidden

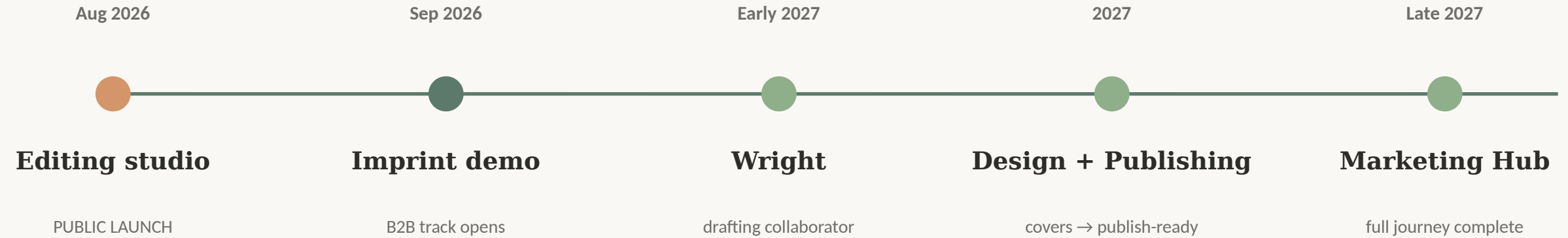
Model-price changes, feature costs, per-user economics — all show up in the ledger within days, not at quarter end.

Investor reporting on tap

Per-user COGS at 100 / 1,000 / 10,000 users is a query, not a promise.

Unit economics as instrument readings — the thing seed investors will ask for, running since day zero.

A series of finished products, not one unfinished platform



- Each release is a launch beat — its own story, its own press, its own conversion spike.
- Each release raises the new-customer price list while existing subscribers keep their price: early believers are locked in, and the price rises with the platform.
- Wright is separately metered — heavy generative drafting never silently erodes tier margins.

Two motions: a funnel for authors, a doorway for imprints

Authors — self-serve funnel

Free manuscript assessment

no card required — the writer community's favourite word is free

Single-project pass £119

commitment without subscription — credits toward membership

Membership £7-£27/mo

the multi-project home for a writing life

Paid tests start this month (\$50–100 trial ads, Meta/X) with per-channel CAC measured from day one. Organic: the communities where indie authors already gather.

Imprints — B2B doorway

- September 2026: demo to the Executive Publisher of a new London imprint backed by The Blair Partnership — a 20–50 author list.
- Publisher collaboration is architected in: publishers join Design, Publishing and Marketing on their authors' books — never the writing space.
- Comparable spend is proven: small imprints pay £600/mo (Consonance) for editorial SaaS today. Our SKU is priced against that floor.
- One imprint contract $\approx$ 25–50 Author-tier subscriptions in revenue — a second axis the model prices at £250–£1,000/mo.

Built, used, and instrumented — before a single ad has run

11

beta authors, grandfathered as
Founding Authors

272

chapters under active editing across 8
manuscripts

4,061

editor-author chat messages in the
live database

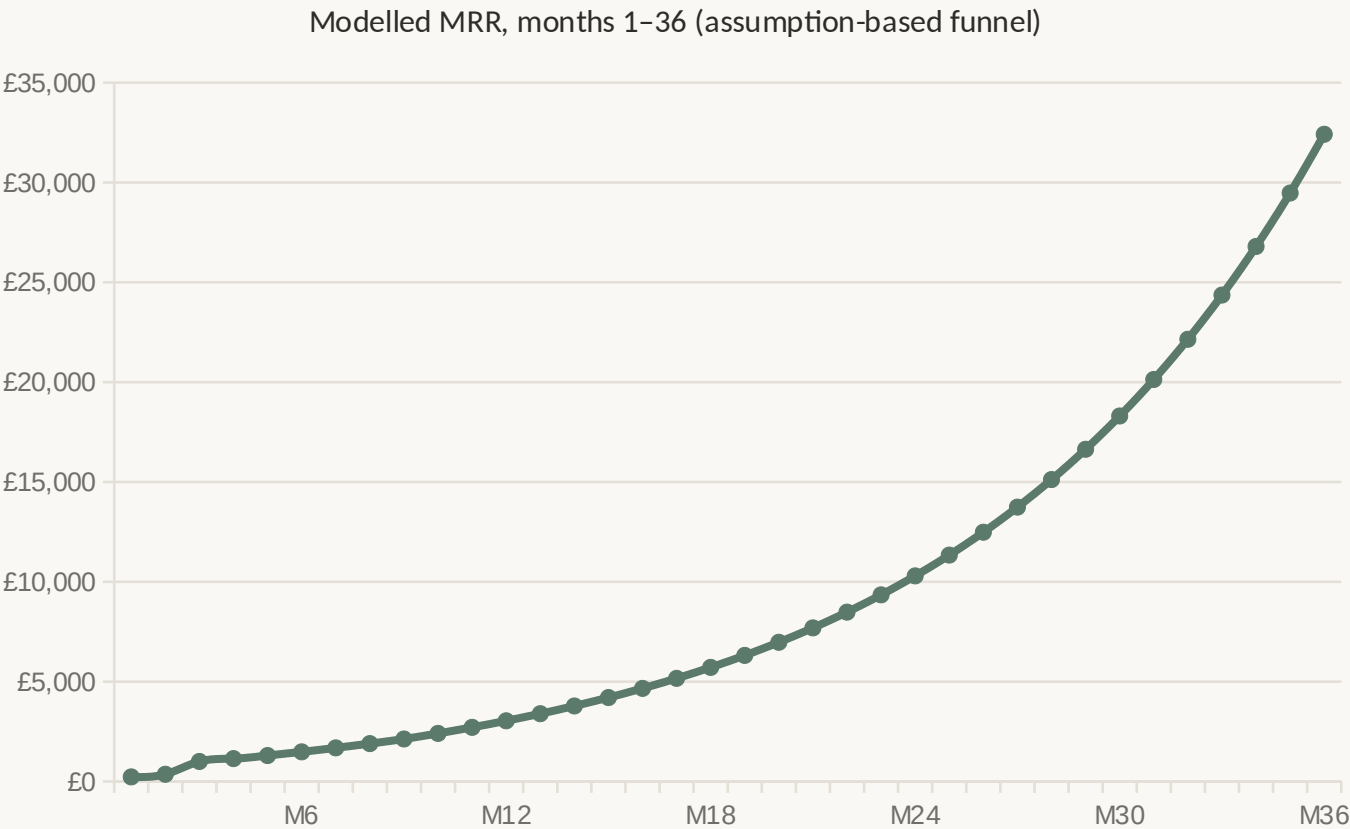
789

tracked editorial findings filed by the AI
team

- Live Stripe billing: three tiers, annual and monthly, one-time pass — catalogue verified in production this week.
- Public launch of the editing studio: this week. Free-assessment funnel opens with it.
- Origin story that sells itself: built for one family member's manuscript, grown into a platform. The first test case is a finished 36-chapter fantasy novel.

Counts read live from the production database, 5 August 2026.

The model: 36 months, monthly, every line tagged by evidence



£32k MRR / 1,573 writers
at month 36 (modelled)

3.3× LTV : CAC
at month 12 on placeholder funnel

55-65% gross margin
editing phase, instrument-backed COGS

£171 LTV
per writer at month-12 economics

Honest labels: COGS lines are measured (live AI-cost ledger); funnel and churn are assumptions until launch data lands — which starts this month.

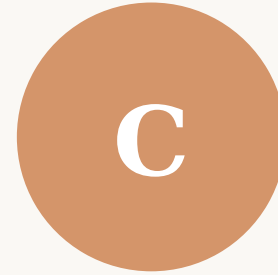
Team



Paul Lyons

Founder

[Bio placeholder — background, contract management & AI systems leadership, Spike Island Studios]



Carl [surname]

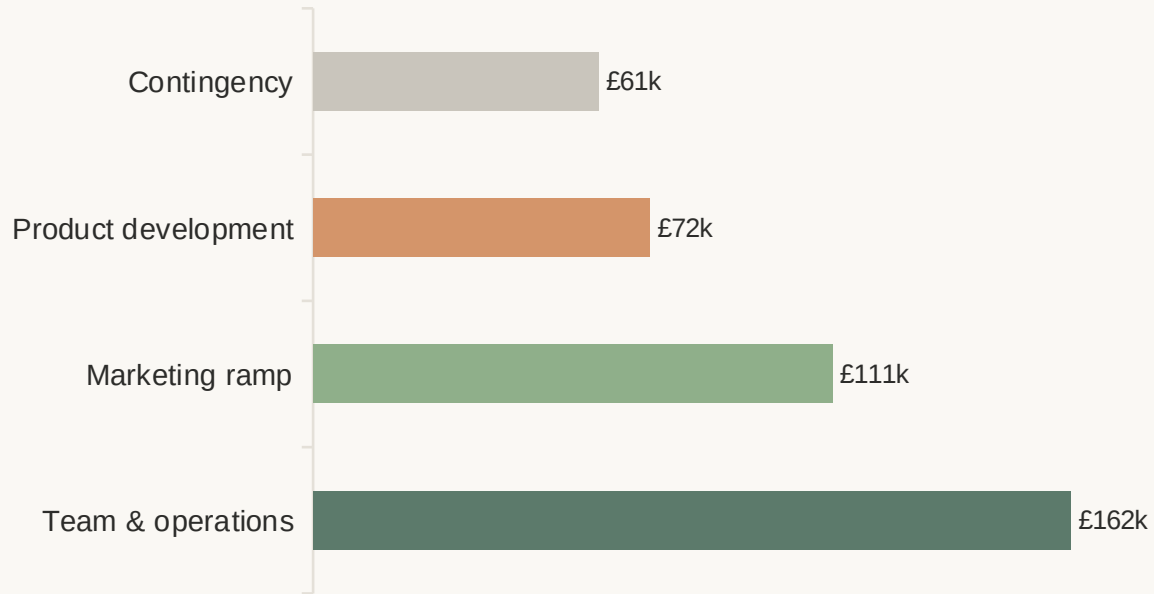
Co-founder — Commercial & Strategy

[Bio placeholder]

Built under Spike Island Studios — the venture studio behind CLARENCE (B2B contract negotiation) and AuthorsLab. Bootstrapped to launch.

The ask: £350,000 for 18 months of proof

£406k plan = £350k raise + £56k modelled gross profit



What it buys

- Public launch scaled: proven acquisition channels with measured CAC (first data weeks after launch)
- The full product line shipped as staged releases — four launch beats, four price steps
- First imprint contract live (September conversation already booked)
- Ledger-calibrated allowances holding $\geq 70\%$ flagship gross margin
- Seed-ready metrics: repeatable channels, LTV/CAC evidence, B2B revenue axis

Structure

£250k SEIS (50% investor income-tax relief) + £100k EIS. Advance assurance in progress.
12–15% dilution implies £2.3–2.9m post-money — in line with UK pre-seed norms.



Writing is a lonely profession.

We're building the team every author deserves.

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